Configure Google Maps with an API Key

Any integration with Google Maps, including Android apps, requires a few steps, specifically:

1. Create an API key with the Google Maps API enabled.
2. Create a secrets file to hold the API key securely.
3. Configure a plugin to read from this secret file.
4. Add the Google Maps dependencies.

Create your API key according to the instructions on the Google Developer site[33] or follow Emily Keller's helpful video.[34] Make sure to enable the Google Maps Platform APIs and SDKs for the API key, which will start with `AIza`.

We'll add the API key to the project with a secrets file. In Android Studio, expand `Gradle Scripts` and right-click `local.properties`. Select New → File and enter `secrets.properties` and press ↩, as shown in the screenshot.